LITSA

Legal Innovation and Technology Student Association

General body meeting. Thursday, September 24, 2026. Sargent Hall 495F.

OUR MISSION

To encourage innovation within the legal profession and promote the use of technology to benefit all

Academic and professional growth	Support academic excellence and professional development.
Access to justice	Make meaningful contributions to closing the access-to-justice gap.
Our alumni	Keep a strong legal network and connection with the people who came before us.

LITSA Constitution, preamble.

WHO WE ARE

The e-board



Sam Darkwa

PRESIDENT · 3L

Product manager turned builder. Came for legal innovation; pursuing AI governance, privacy and cyber.



Noy Lohr

VICE PRESIDENT · 2L

Brings in privacy and AI-regulation programming, and legal tech companies that want students using their tools.



Morgan Walters

CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER · 2L

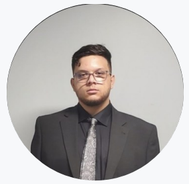
Worked at a legal tech startup building a criminal-law search engine. Plans to prosecute.



Kevin Shang

TREASURER · 2L

Computer science background. Wants to make AI understandable for law students. Summer judicial intern, Essex Superior Court.



Pedro Barbosa

TECHNOLOGY LIAISON · 2L

Has programmed most of his life and is the technician for his family's PC-building business. Worked in legal tech this summer.



Cenia Lowry

2L REPRESENTATIVE

Spent the summer at an immigration firm. Making LITSA easier to get into for her class.



KP Hunsinger

EVENING REPRESENTATIVE · 4L

Ten years in higher-ed administration. ODR clinic LIT fellow; worked on the 1A divorce guided interviews this summer.

YOUR CLASS REPRESENTATIVES

Every section has one



Ryan Kahley

1A

Computer engineer. AI governance work on the EU AI Act.



Garrett Girgasky

1B

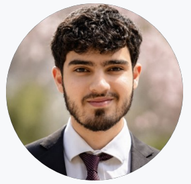
Statistics and economics. Data analytics.



Morgan Budovsky

1C

Finishing a master's in financial technology.



Marwan Kiswani

1D

Former paralegal. Co-founded Lotari, a legal automation startup.



Ananya Pampana

1D

Following legal AI and innovation, from classroom to conference floor.



Reyna Fisher

1E

Chief Innovation Officer at a family law firm.



Darrell Mensah

3L

President of the Men of Color Law Student Association. Wants to teach AI for coursework.

LAST SPRING

We build things

Seven teams picked a legal scenario and started building, with no preparation. Two hours later several teams had working prototypes. The best came from two first-year evening students with full-time jobs.



This photograph leads National Jurist's August 2026 feature on schools preparing lawyers for the AI era. The caption names LITSA.

Suffolk LIT Lab, April 9 2026. National Jurist, August 5 2026.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The work lawyers do has been reshaped three times already. The fourth is happening during your degree.



THREE SHIFTS

Each one moved the work. None removed the lawyer.

1970s to 1990s

Research

From the stacks to Westlaw and Lexis. The associate who could find the case stopped being the scarce one.

2000s

Discovery

From boxes of paper to e-discovery and predictive coding. A million documents became a weekend, and a practice area became a specialty.

2010s to now

Drafting

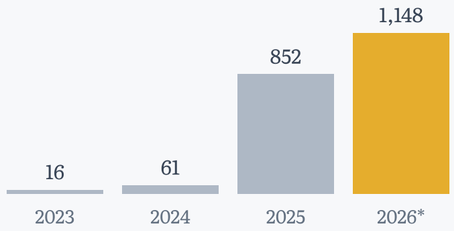
From forms and precedent banks to document automation, and now drafting assistants. Where the billable hour goes moves again.

AI, in four numbers from the last three years

COURTS

1,148

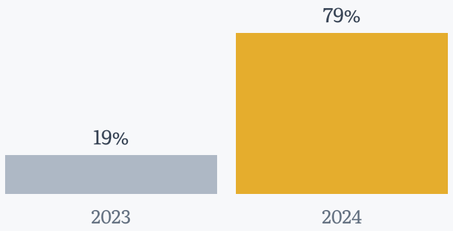
court decisions this year involving AI-fabricated citations or content. There were 16 in 2023.



LAWYERS

79%

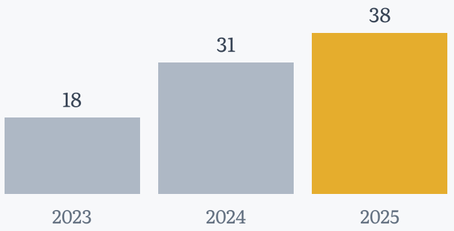
of legal professionals used AI in 2024, up from 19% in 2023. Other surveys measure lower; all of them rose.



LEGISLATURES

38

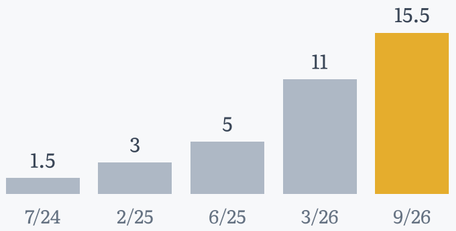
states enacted AI laws or resolutions in 2025, up from 18 in 2023. All 50 introduced bills.



MONEY

$15.5B

is what investors valued Harvey, a legal AI company, at this month. It was $1.5B in July 2024.



*2026 through September 23. Damien Charlotin, AI Hallucination Cases database (worldwide). Clio Legal Trends Report, 2024. NCSL, AI legislation 2023 and 2025. Harvey funding announcements.

WHERE WE ARE NOW

Six areas where the rules are still being written

None of these is a technology problem with a technology answer. They are practice areas.

AI in practice

Fabricated citations and sanctions. Who approves a tool, who answers for it when it is wrong, and what you owe the client and the court when you used one. Firms and legal departments call this governance, and they are staffing it.

Cybersecurity

Breach notice deadlines that differ by state. Vendor liability. Incident response as a legal function, and the duty to safeguard client data.

Employment

Algorithmic hiring, automated decisions, and the audit rules arriving to govern them.

Data privacy

State laws stacking up with no federal floor. Consent, dark patterns, biometrics, kids.

Intellectual property

Training data and fair use. Who owns model output. Trade secrets walking out the door in a chat window.

Access to justice

Self-help tools, court forms, and unauthorized practice rules. The lane Suffolk's LIT Lab has worked in for a decade.

THE LIT UMBRELLA

Where it lives at Suffolk

More of the work

Technology transactions	Licensing, SaaS, and the contracts products run on.
Emerging companies and venture	Startups, financings, and the counsel that grows with them.
E-discovery	Evidence that lives in systems, and the tools to find it.
Legal operations	Knowledge management, innovation roles, and how legal work gets run.

At Suffolk

The LIT Center	The concentration, the LLM, and the programs around them.
The LIT Lab	Builds tools with courts and legal aid. Runs LIT Con every spring.
The ODR Innovation Clinic	Online dispute resolution, with the AAA.
Journal of High Technology Law	Suffolk's journal for technology and the law.
Fellow student orgs	The IP Law Students Association and the Data Privacy and Cybersecurity Law Association.

SUFFOLK HAS BEEN AT THIS SINCE 2013

LITSA is the student end of it

2013

The Institute opens with a talk by Richard Susskind. The JD concentration is the first in the country.

2018

National Jurist ranks the program number one for legal technology, out of thirty schools.

2022

Aubrie Souza is National Jurist Law Student of the Year, for smart forms built in the LIT Lab.

2024

The AAA and Suffolk open the ODR Innovation Clinic. A 24-credit LLM is announced.

2025

The first LLM class enrolls. Suffolk and AWS run a generative AI hackathon, and National Jurist names Suffolk in its twelve most innovative law schools.

2026

Jack Brandt, Law Student of the Year. Four faculty on the Top 50 Legal Innovators in Academia. Top tier of the Technology Law Honor Roll. Every first-year now completes an AI learning track.

Law.com and the Suffolk LIT Center, 2013. Suffolk University news, 2018, 2024 and 2025. National Jurist, 2025 and 2026. National Law Review, 2026.

THE CURRICULUM

Everything you can actually take

CORE

TAKE 3 OF 4

Twenty-First Century Legal Profession	2
Process Improvement and Legal Project Mgmt	2
Legal Technology for Small Firm Practice	3
Generative AI & the Delivery of Legal Services	2

ELECTIVES

	CREDITS
Artificial Intelligence & the Law	3
Blockchain, Cryptocurrency, and the Law†	1
Business of Practice: Hit the Ground Running	2
Business Planning	2
Cybersecurity Law and Policy	2
Decision Making and Choice Management	3
Design Thinking for Lawyers & Business Pros	3
Digital Evidence	2
E-Discovery Law†	2
Emerging AI Regulatory Frameworks	2
Emerging Issues: IT & Transnational Business†	2
Law Practice Planning: Law as an Enterprise	3
Lawyers as Leaders	2
Legal Operations and Management of Services	2
Modern LPS: Legal Innovation & Technology	3
Negotiating Business Transactions	3
ODR†	3
Privacy/Data Security Requirements†	3
Problem Solving: Legal Writing for Practice†	2
Race, Ethical AI, and Cyber Civil Rights	2
Transactional Skills	3

LLM ONLY

	CREDITS
Biotechnology Business & the Law	3
Negotiation with AI	–

JD CONCENTRATION

17 credits

Three of the four core courses. Three electives totaling seven credits. An externship or a clinic. A writing requirement, and a 3.25 average in the concentration.

LLM

24 credits

Master of Laws in Legal Innovation & Technology. Three core courses, ten credits of technology electives, seven of innovative approaches. One year full time.

BOTH TOGETHER

24 credits

The JD/LLM splits evenly. Twelve credits on the JD side, six at the business school, and a six-credit capstone you choose, which can be building an actual tool.

Suffolk Law concentration and LLM course pages, verified August 2026. † Listed by the concentration but not on the 2026–27 schedule. Credits for Negotiation with AI are not published.

IN THE BUILDING

The people who built this are down the hall

Full-time faculty only. Adjuncts who do this work by day teach many of the LIT courses.

Andrew Perlman	Dean since 2015 and Vice President for Academic Innovation. Chief reporter of the ABA Commission on Ethics 20/20, which rewrote the Model Rules for technology. Founded the Institute in 2013, a decade before ChatGPT. Tracks the AI policies of 180 law schools.
Dyane O'Leary	Professor of Legal Writing and Assistant Dean for Distance Education. Directs the LIT Center. Taught Suffolk's first generative AI course. Mass. Lawyers Weekly Top Women in Law 2026, ABA Women of Legal Tech, Fastcase 50.
David Colarusso	Senior Practitioner in Residence and co-director of the LIT Lab. Former public defender and high school physics teacher. ABA Legal Rebel, Fastcase 50.
Quinten Steenhuis	Practitioner in Residence and co-director of the LIT Lab. Twelve years as a housing attorney at Greater Boston Legal Services, where he built the MADE eviction-defense tool. Founder of Lemma Legal. ABA Legal Rebel, Fastcase 50.
Gabriel Teninbaum	Assistant Dean of Innovation. Built the concentration. Suffolk Law 2005, at night while in the U.S. Secret Service. Founded SpacedRepetition.com; author of Productizing Legal Work (2021). Visiting professor at the MIT Media Lab. Fastcase 50, ABA Journal Web 100.
Hon. John Casey	Retired Chief Justice of the Probate and Family Court, Suffolk Law 1982. Practitioner in Residence for the ODR Innovation Clinic. On the American Arbitration Association's Massachusetts family law panel. Mass. Bar Foundation Great Friend of Justice, 2025.

WHERE IT LEADS

Suffolk alumni are already doing this work

1994 **Cheree McAlpine**
Chief Legal Officer, Zoom.

1995 **R. Stanton Dodge**
Chief Legal Officer, DraftKings.

1997 **Chris McKenna**
Boston managing partner, Foley & Lardner. Co-chairs its AI practice.

1997 **B. Stephanie Siegmann**
Chairs cyber and privacy at Hinckley Allen, and co-chairs AI.

2001 **Kosta Ligris**
Founder of Stavvy, digital mortgage closings. Teaches at MIT Sloan.

2007 **Brian Kuhn**
Co-founded IBM Watson Legal.

2008 **Sheriece Perry**
Runs court services and law libraries for the Massachusetts Trial Court.

2010 **Morris Singer**
AWS, Boston. Ran the Suffolk generative AI hackathon.

2015 **Vedika Ahlgren**
Director of Orrick Labs, Boston. A graduate of this concentration.

2015 **Gerald Glover III**
Among the first legal solutions architects in BigLaw.

2016 **Julia Rodgers**
CEO of HelloPrenup. Shark Tank, Fastcase 50, Inc. Female Founders 500.

2016 **Stephanie Fattman**
Register of Probate, Worcester. First in the state to bring in e-filing.

2022 **Aubrie Souza**
National Jurist Law Student of the Year. Now at the NCSC.

2026 **Jack Brandt**
National Jurist Law Student of the Year. Built the Military Benefits Assistant.

Listed by graduation year. Firm bios (Foley, Hinckley Allen). Orrick. Suffolk Law Magazine. National Jurist. LawSites. NCSC. MIT. Company profiles.

WHAT THE WORK ACTUALLY IS

You do not need to code

Most people in this field never write software. The fastest-growing piece is governance: policy, compliance, contracting, and deciding what a tool is allowed to do. Certifications exist for it, and employers ask.

30%

of firms report using AI tools, up from 11% a year earlier.

ABA Legal Technology Survey, 2024

85%

of legal departments now have dedicated AI oversight or resources for it.

CLOC State of the Industry, March 2026

22%

of organizations have a visible AI strategy, while 80% of professionals expect AI to reshape the work. That gap is the job market.

Thomson Reuters, 2025

BOSTON

The work happens within a mile of this room

Firms with an innovation lead who sits here

The title varies. The job is deciding what the firm adopts, and how it gets used.

GOODWIN	Knowledge and Innovation
MINTZ	Innovation Office
FOLEY HOAG	Knowledge and Innovation
Nutter uncommon law	Practice Support

Legal technology based in Massachusetts

Two of these were founded by Suffolk alumni.

LinkSquares

ANAQUA®

MARVERI

Descrybe.

Proof℠

juro

Stavvy

HELLO PRENUP

Firm and company sites, September 2026. Logos are the companies' own. ACC Annual Meeting is in Boston October 4 to 7. ClioCon is at the Hynes October 26 and 27. The ALTA gala is in this building October 25.

BEYOND LITSA

Legal tech events this year

Sun, Oct 25	**American Legal Technology Awards**	At Suffolk Law. Ticketed; last year the LIT Lab ran a free student reception beforehand.
Oct 26–27	**ClioCon**	At the Hynes. The virtual conference is free.
Nov 12–13	**New England Experiential Conference**	At Suffolk Law.
First Wednesdays	**Document Assembly Line workshop**	Suffolk LIT Lab. Virtual and free.
Apr 5, 2027	**LIT Con**	The LIT Lab's annual legal innovation and technology conference. Online and here at Suffolk.

WHAT LITSA HAS BUILT

Tools you can use tonight

suffolklitsa.org	The events calendar for legal tech around Boston. Every concentration, every course, 101 databases, 391 study aids, with the source linked.
chat.suffolklitsa.org	Answers questions from 170 official Suffolk pages, and links the page it came from. Career resources and deadlines are what people ask about most.
/watch	Courts sanctioning lawyers over AI, refreshed every Monday.
The newsletter	Four issues so far. About 330 people on the list.
And more to come	A Boston legal technology page is next, and after that it is whatever the committees decide to take on.

COMMITTEES

Pick one, or a few

Up and running by spring. Light by design: a way to run LITSA better, not something that eats your semester. Committees work on the LITSA Discord, and invites go out after tonight.

Build	Tools: the assistant, the site, tools for clinics. Spot problems, decide what gets built, test it with people. Coding optional.
Events	Panels, lunch-and-learns, and the spring challenge.
Research and Writing	Track AI, privacy and cyber law. Short explainers and newsletter pieces.
Skills	Workshops on AI for coursework and the legal tools firms use.
Network	Alumni, firms and companies. The panel pool and our partners.
Communications	The newsletter, Instagram, LinkedIn, and the boards around school.

THIS YEAR

What is on the calendar

Wed, Nov 4	**Law of technology panel**	6:00pm, with a reception. Co-hosted with IP Law and Data Privacy.
TBD	**Lunch and learn**	The entry-level legal job, and what changed about it.
Spring, TBD	**Technology of law panel**	Technology in practice, from the people using it.
Spring, TBD	**Legal AI Innovation Challenge**	One evening, one real problem, whatever you can build.

HOW TO GET INVOLVED

Anyone can contribute something this year

Law school is busy, and nobody has to do everything. The tools now make it possible to actually ship things. The goal is to build that habit this year so it keeps going after us.

Sign in before you leave	Name, email, section, and check any committee you'd try.
Bring a problem	Something slow, broken or confusing at school, at work, or in life. That is how every project starts.
Come to one thing	November 4. Bring a classmate.

QUESTIONS

Find us

suffolklitsa.org
Calendar, resources, curriculum, the watch page.

The assistant
Ask it something.

LinkedIn
Follow LITSA.

Instagram
@litsa_suls